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INTERVIEW

« I was always determined and fixed on making it to F1. That childhood dream is now becoming a reality »

ARVID LINDBLAD

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The path through modern motorsport is rarely a straight sprint. More often, it is a grind, where careers can stall as easily as they advance. That reality makes

Arvid Lindblad's story stand out. From the demands of karting to the unforgiving tiers of junior formula racing, his progression has gathered rare momentum, carrying him into the sport's top echelon, Formula One.

A standout talent from the Red Bull Junior Programme, Lindblad is now gearing up to drive for Racing Bulls in 2026. Born in a Swedish-Indian household based in the UK, his multicultural upbringing has played a significant role in shaping both his identity and his career.

In an exclusive chat with *Sportstar*, the 18-year-old reflects on his journey, the transitions between

categories, the support systems around him, and the challenge that lies ahead.

You have worked towards this since you were five. What first sparked your love for racing?

It all started on my paternal side of the family. My paternal grandfather is an avid motorsport fan. He will watch anything with wheels and an engine. He absolutely loves it. When my dad was a teenager, they got into motocross together. Unfortunately, they did not really have the money, so my dad had to stop very early. He only did it for a short time.

That passion carried through to my dad. When I was three, he bought me a motocross bike. I did not instantly love it, and it was a bit too much for my mum as well, so that died out quite quickly. When I was five, I went karting for the first time

and I loved it from the beginning. I do not really know why, but I just did.

I get asked a lot about when the dream started to feel real. It is always hard to answer. When I was in F3 or F4, it probably started to feel more tangible. But when I began, it was a hobby, though not entirely. I was always determined and fixed on making it to F1. That childhood dream is now becoming a reality.

You famously set yourself a five-year target, even telling Lando Norris you would see him in Formula One. You have kept to that timeline. How prepared do you feel now?

It is not an easy question to answer. It is funny that you bring up the Lando story and how it has come full circle. From the start, I always believed I could make it to Formula One. If I am honest, I do not know if I